

Oscar Larnce



Things are going to get worse for the Baylor Bears. Saturday night their old nemesis, Texas Tech, comes to Heart O' Texas Coliseum. Another defeat will just about eliminate Carroll Dawson's team from the Southwest Conference race. Baylor has defeated Tech only twice in four seasons. All except one Red Raider victory were lopsided. Tech isn't as good this year with Rick Bullock departed but Gerald Myers always finds a way to beat Dawson. After Tech, the Bears go to Houston for a battle with All-American Otis Birdsong and his Cougar playmates. Then Rice and Arkansas come to Waco. Baylor will be lucky to win one out of three playing as it is now. The Arkansas game will be on television, where the Bears usually flop.

Southern Methodist continues the big surprise of the conference scramble. But the Mustangs have tough going ahead. They still have two games each with Tech, Arkansas and Houston. That will make or break the Mustangs and go a long way toward deciding the champion. Arkansas is the leading contender for the first time since 1958, when the Razorbacks did Doc Hayes' SMU team for the title. All-time Arkansas great Glen Rose coached the Razorbacks, Arkansas won the play-off game, 61-55, then lost to Oklahoma State in the Western Regional, 65-40. Fred Grim of Arkansas and SMU's Buck Herrscher were All-Conference. Gerald Myers also was Tech's first All-Conference player that season.

FIVE MORE will be added to the Texas High School Basketball Hall of Fame of Athens this year. They will represent periods prior to 1930 through 1969. Nominees prior to 1930 are Benny Tompkins of Athens, Andy Cohen of El Paso, Abb Curtis of Fort Worth, Owen McDowell of Dallas Sunset and Hub Friery of San Antonio Brackenridge. Candidates for 1930-39 are Calvin Battise of Big Sandy, Young Bussey of Houston San Jacinto, Clifton McNeely of Slidell, Kiko Martinez of El Paso and Foster Bullock of Livingston. For 1940-49: Mario Palafox of El Paso, Billy Henry of Dallas Highland Park, Buck Overall of Cushing, Tom Hamilton of Dallas Crozier Tech and Gus Ford of Amarillo. Candidates for the 1950-59 era are Kelly Duncan of Cayuga, Carroll Broussard of Port Arthur, Larry Showater of Dallas Adamson, Gerald Mydts of Borger and Johnny Johnston of Jacksonville. For 1960-69: Dub Malaise of Odessa, John Hatch of Buna, Jerry Kroll of Spring Branch, William Gaines of Dallas Madison and Bill Overall of San Antonio.

Tompkins is rated by many as the greatest high school player of them all. He starred on the Athens championship

teams with brother John, later at SMU. Andy Cohen, later a major league baseball player, was on the first All-State team in 1921. Curtis was Texas' first All-American in 1925. He was a long-time basketball official and SWC executive. Tompkins is our choice. We skipped the 1930-39 era because we couldn't remember any of the nominees. Bussey was a football star at Louisiana State. Henry, twice All-Conference and twice All-American at Rice in 1944-45, is easy winner in the 1940-49 period. The 1950-59 choice is Broussard, thrice All-Conference at Texas A&M (1960, 61 and 62). Carroll Dawson also was on the 1960 All-Conference team. Texas Tech's Dub Malaise, three time All-Conference, is best of the 1960-69 candidates.

Athens won five state championships from 1929 through 1934 and also was national champion during that period. Buster Brannon, former Rice and Texas Christian coach, starred on Athens' teams, Waco City Commissioner Catfish Smith coached at Carey in 1937 and won the state title with only seven players.

TEMPLE WAS CHAMPION in 1932, when Athens didn't make the state tournament. Athens returned for two straight titles to end its dominance. No Athens team has won since. Jeff Davis, Slidell, San Antonio Sidney Lanier and Prairie Lea dominated the 1940s with two championships each. Waco was in the state tournament seven times—six of them in a row. Buna won four titles during the 1950-59 era. McAdoo was champion three times in the 1960-69 period. Buna, Snook, Huntington and Kennard won two each.

Basketball will have an answer to the Heisman Trophy. Los Angeles Athletic Club will award the Wooden Trophy to the nation's outstanding college player selected in a vote by 1,000 sports writers and sportscasters. The trophy, of course, is named in honor of retired UCLA super coach John Wooden.

You can't blame the New York Yankees' Thurman Munson for being unhappy about his contract when Reggie Jackson was paid so much. Munson has been the Yankees' best player for seven years and is one of those who deserves a salary in keeping with his performance. Texas Rangers bonus boy David Clyde is expected to be full strength when spring training starts. He had surgery on his left shoulder last season after pitching briefly at Sacramento. The doctor said he was "more than happy" after a recent examination. Clyde is the \$100,000 Houston bonus boy who has been having arm miseries since he joined the Rangers. Chris Needham, former Temple sports announcer, is now with an Oklahoma City TV station.